

Order Damage - Agent Knowledge Base

How to identify transit damage, collect safe evidence, choose replacement or refund, and escalate hazardous-product cases.

Prototype disclaimer

Synthetic sample policy for prototyping and RAG evaluation. This document is fictional operational guidance, not a statement of any real company's policy. Adapt, validate, and approve it before production use.

Retrieval metadata

Applies to: customer support agents, ticket triage agents, and automated support agents

Recommended ticket tags: damaged_item, transit_damage, hazardous_item, photo_evidence, replacement

Policy status: synthetic / test corpus

Policy summary

Damage claims cover products that arrive broken, crushed, leaking, unusable, or with significant shipping-related cosmetic damage. Minor packaging damage without product damage is not automatically a product-damage claim.

Default resolution window

Ask customers to report transit damage within 7 calendar days of delivery when practical. Claims reported later may still be reviewed, but require stronger evidence and supervisor approval after 30 days.

Decision rules

Situation	Agent action	Escalate when
Product visibly damaged on arrival	Offer replacement or refund if evidence and order match support the claim.	High-value item, safety hazard, or pattern of repeated claims.
Only shipping carton is damaged	Ask whether the product itself is affected. If product is fine, no compensation is normally required.	Customer reports hidden damage discovered after opening.
Item is leaking, swollen, hot, smoking, or chemically unsafe	Tell customer to stop using/handling it and move to a safe location only if they can do so safely. Do not request return shipment until safety review.	Always escalate immediately to safety/quality specialist.
Customer reports defect after normal use	Classify as defect/warranty rather than transit damage.	Warranty eligibility is unclear or safety issue is present.
Damage evidence unavailable	Do not automatically deny. Use order value, claim history, description, and risk rules to decide whether evidence can be waived.	Evidence waiver exceeds agent authority.

Evidence guidance

Agents may request photos of the product, inner packaging, outer shipping label area, and damage. Do not require the customer to include faces, IDs, payment cards, or unrelated personal information. For low-value items, evidence may be waived according to agent authority.

Resolution rules

Eligible claims may receive a replacement or refund, but not both for the same unit. A return may be waived for damaged low-value goods, contaminated goods, broken glass, leaking goods, or items a carrier refuses to transport. Never instruct a customer to mail a hazardous item without an approved procedure.

Suggested ticket fields

issue_type=damage; order_id; item_sku; delivery_date; report_date; damage_type; safety_risk=yes|no; photo_received=yes|no; return_required=yes|no|pending_review; resolution=replace|refund|deny|escalate

Frequently asked questions

Q: My item arrived broken. What do I do?

A: Verify the order and item, ask for a brief description and appropriate evidence, then offer a replacement or refund if the claim is eligible.

Q: The box is dented but the product is fine. Can I get a refund?

A: Packaging damage alone is not normally enough for a product-damage refund. Ask whether the item itself is damaged or unusable.

Q: Do I have to send a dangerous or leaking item back?

A: Not until a safety specialist approves a return method. Customers should not be asked to ship hazardous, leaking, smoking, swollen, or otherwise unsafe items through a normal return label.

Q: I cannot send photos. Will my claim be denied?

A: Not automatically. Evidence can sometimes be waived for low-value or otherwise credible claims, subject to agent authority.

Q: Can I get both a replacement and a refund?

A: No, not for the same damaged unit unless a supervisor approves a specific corrective exception.

Q: I noticed damage after using the product for two weeks. Is that shipping damage?

A: Usually that should be evaluated as a product defect or warranty issue unless the customer can show the damage was present on arrival.

Agent response principle

State what is known, distinguish it from what is estimated, give the customer the next concrete step, and never promise an outcome outside the rules in this knowledge base.